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BAGONG PILIPINAS

CC 101 – Introduction to Computing

Laboratory Worksheet No. 1 | Week 3: Computer Components I – Hardware (CO2)

"Know Your Machine": Exploring the Computer Unit You Are Using

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Computer Unit Used (Desktop/Laptop, brand):	Date: September 26, 2026

I. Objectives

At the end of this activity, you should be able to:

- Identify the major hardware components of the computer unit you are using and describe the function of each.
- Use built-in Windows 11 tools to inspect and record your computer's technical specifications.
- Distinguish between input, output, processing, and storage devices on an actual working computer.
- Document your exploration accurately and reflect on what you learned.

II. Materials Needed

- A computer unit running Windows 11 (school laboratory PC or personal laptop/desktop)
- This worksheet (printed copy, or the digital file to fill out and submit)
- Optional: smartphone camera, to photograph the physical unit and ports for your own reference

III. Background

Every computer, whether a desktop tower or a laptop, is built from hardware components that fall into four general categories: input devices (send data into the computer, e.g., keyboard, mouse), output devices (present processed data to the user, e.g., monitor, speakers), the processing/storage unit (CPU, RAM, and drives that compute and hold data), and ports/peripherals (connectors that link external devices to the system unit). Windows 11 also provides several built-in tools — Settings, System Information, Device Manager, and Task Manager — that let you inspect these components without opening the case. This activity uses both direct observation and these software tools.

IV. Procedure

Part A – Physical Inspection (5–10 minutes)

1. Examine the computer unit in front of you. If it is a desktop, look at the system unit (tower/case); if it is a laptop, examine the whole chassis.
2. List all the input devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., keyboard, mouse, touchpad, webcam, microphone).
3. List all the output devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., monitor/screen, speakers, headphone jack).
4. Locate the available ports on the unit (USB-A, USB-C, HDMI, audio jack, Ethernet/LAN, power, etc.) and note what each one is typically used to connect.

Part B – System Identification (Settings)

5. Click Start → Settings → System → About.

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6. Record the Device name, Processor, Installed RAM, Device ID, and System type shown under Device specifications.
7. Scroll down to Windows specifications and record the Edition, Version, and OS build.

Part C – Detailed Hardware Check (System Information)

8. Press the Windows key, type System Information, and open it (this runs the msinfo32 tool).
9. On the System Summary page, record the System Manufacturer, System Model, BIOS Version/Date, and Total Physical Memory.

Part D – Device Manager Exploration

10. Right-click the Start button and choose Device Manager.
11. Expand at least six (6) categories — for example: Display adapters, Network adapters, Sound/video/game controllers, Disk drives, Keyboards, Mice and other pointing devices, and Universal Serial Bus controllers.
12. For each category you expand, write down the specific device name Windows lists (this is the exact model of that component in your unit).

Part E – Performance and Storage Check (Task Manager)

13. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and click the Performance tab.
14. Record the CPU name, base speed, and number of cores; the total Memory (RAM) and its speed; and the Disk type (HDD or SSD) and capacity.

Part F – Software Snapshot (Optional / Bonus)

15. Go to Settings → Apps → Installed apps. List five (5) installed applications and classify each as System Software or Application Software.

V. Data and Findings

Table 1. System Identification Summary (Parts B & C)

Item	Your Findings
Device name	DESKTOP-4MKSC1R
Processor	12th Gen Intel (R) Core (TM) i5-12400, 2500 Mhz, 6 Core (s), Logical Process.
Installed RAM	16.0 GB
Device ID	635A5817-6B5D-4DD7-BDB1-0BD91DB6852E
System type (32-bit / 64-bit)	x64-based PC
Windows edition	Windows 10 Pro
Windows version	22H2

Item	Your Findings
OS build	19045.5011
System manufacturer	Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.
System model	MS-7D48
BIOS version / date	American Megatrends International, LLC,A,EO, 1/11/2024
Total physical memory	11.9 GB

Table 2. Physical Components Observed (Part A)

Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
Keyboard	Input	Used to type letters,numbers,and command
Mouse	Input	control cursor; clicks and selects items
Monitor	Output	Displays texts,images and screen output
System Unit/ CPU	Processing	Main part that processes data and runs programs
RAM (MEMORY)	Storage (Temporary)	11.9 GB total; stores data currently in use
Hard drive /SSD	Storage (Permanent	Saves files, apps, and OS even when powered off
Power Supply Port	Port	Where power cord connects to the computer
Ethernet/USB port	Port	For internet connection or plugging in devices

Table 3. Device Manager Findings (Part D)

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Display adapters	Intel(R) UHD Graphics 730

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Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Network adapters	Realtek PCIe GbE Family Controller
Sound, video and game controllers	High Definition Audio Device
Disk drives	TEAM T253256GB
Keyboards	HID Keyboard Device
Mice and other pointing devices	HID- compliant mouse
Universal Serial Bus controllers	Generic USB Hub

Table 4. Software Snapshot (Part F, Optional / Bonus)

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)

VI. Realization (Reflection)

In two to four sentences each, answer the following in your own words.

1. What did you discover about your own computer unit that you did not know before doing this activity?

I found out my computer's exact model, BIOS version, and how much real memory it actually has. Before this, I just used it without knowing these details existed. It was interesting to see exactly when the BIOS was updated and what system I'm really running. Now I understand my computer better than just seeing it as a tool.

2. Which hardware component do you think matters most to how your computer performs, and why?

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I think the CPU (Processor) matters most because it acts like the brain that handles every task and instruction. A faster processor means the computer runs programs quicker and responds without lag. While memory and storage are important, the CPU controls how fast everything else works. It basically sets the overall speed and capability of the whole system.

3. How might knowing your computer's hardware and software specifications help you as a future IT/CS professional?

Knowing these specs will help me check if a computer can run certain programs or handle upgrades. It will let me troubleshoot problems and recommend the right parts or tools for different users. I'll also be able to match software requirements with hardware capabilities properly. This knowledge is basic but essential for fixing, maintaining, and building systems in my future career.

4. What difficulties, if any, did you encounter while completing this activity, and how did you resolve them?

At first, I had trouble finding where to see the full system information and opening Device Manager. I also got confused by some of the technical terms shown on the screen. To fix this, I followed the steps given in our lesson and looked up simple guides on how to access these tools. I double-checked what I saw and matched it carefully to what was asked. Asking a classmate also helped me make sure I was looking at the right details.

VII. Scoring Guide

Criteria	Description	Points
Completeness	All tables (1–4) and required fields are filled out.	30
Accuracy	Recorded specifications and device names match what the tools actually show.	30
Realization / Reflection	Answers are thoughtful, specific to the student's own unit, and well written.	30
Neatness & Timeliness	Worksheet is legible/well-formatted and submitted on time.	10
Total		**100**

Checked by: **Score:** / 100

Instructor's Signature over Printed Name / Date

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